RHTP Awardee Announcement

The Utah Department of Health and Human Services (DHHS) is preparing to formally announce the grant awardees for the Rural Health Transformation Program (RHTP), supported by the $195,743,566 first-year award from CMS.

In Utah's RHTP several key activities have been contracted with a designated fiscal agent. A fiscal agent (also designated as a lead subrecipient, administrative partner, or consortium administrator) is an authorized state agency or contracted partner that receives primary grant allocations from Utah DHHS to provide fiscal stewardship, administrative oversight, and regulatory compliance.

Rather than expending all funds internally, Fiscal Agents administer competitive Requests for Applications (RFAs) and Requests for Proposals (RFPs). These open solicitations disburse subgrant funding directly to eligible rural hospitals, clinics, EMS providers, school districts, agricultural businesses, and local community organizations across all 25 designated rural Utah counties. Additionally, some lead partners will be soliciting interest from organizations to participate in activities such as community care hubs and value-based care models.

In the announcement below, entities designated as [Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator] launch competitive funding calls or solicit participation interest and are open to all eligible rural applicants.

PATH Initiative

PATH 1.1: Rural Food Infrastructure

Awardee: Utah Department of Agriculture and Food (UDAF)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: UDAF-Food Security Grant **Utah Food Security Grant**

Amount: $11,000,000.00

Project Scope: Awards competitive subgrant funding to rural food producers, processors, cold storage facilities, and slaughterhouses; funds the USU Extension E-Commerce Accelerator; and executes the 'Utah's Own' rural food supply chain campaign to increase local produce retention across all 25 rural counties. Applications for year 1 were solicited from July 21 – August 31, 2026, UDAF is currently finalizing contracts.

PATH 1.2: Gold Medal Schools Program

Awardee: Utah State Board of Education (USBE)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **https://www.schools.utah.gov/curr/goldmedalschools**

Email: shanda.stenger@schools.utah.gov

Amount: $3,188,804.00

Project Scope: Passes funding directly to rural Local Education Agencies (LEAs) in 3rd-6th class counties to re-establish the Gold Medal Schools program, deploying structured physical activity, nutrition education, student wellness, and mental health programs. USBE is currently working directly with LEAs and schools to pass this funding through.

PATH 1.3: Physical Activity Infrastructure

Awardee: Utah Department of Transportation (UDOT)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **Email Kristen Hoschouer khoschouer@utah.gov**

Amount: $11,000,000.00

Project Scope: Constructs built environment active transportation infrastructure connecting rural residents to health services, including sidewalk gap closures, active transportation corridor repairs, and trailhead amenities/wayfinding across rural counties and Tribal lands. UDOT is currently working with regional administrators to identify qualifying projects. This award also includes funding for non-emergency transportation.

PATH 1.4: Community Care Hub

Awardee: Comagine

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **https://comagine.org/**

Amount: $2,000,000.00

Project Scope: Establishes Utah's first statewide Community Care Hub (CCH) system to manage social determinants of health (SDOH) screenings, closed-loop referrals, and healthcare/social service reimbursement.

PATH 1.5: Behavioral Health - Primary Care Integration

Awardee: Community Health Center (CHC)

Contact: **ruralht@utah.gov**

Amount: $1,139,572.00

Project Scope: Integrates primary care and behavioral health at Tremonton (Bear River) and Brigham City clinics, implementing warm handoff protocols, EMR mapping, and tele-psychiatry in partnership with Bear River Mental Health and Bear River Health Department.

PATH 1.5: Behavioral Health - Primary Care Integration

Awardee: Moab Valley Healthcare (MVH)

Contact: **www.moabfreehealthclinic.org. or Email: director@moabfreehealthclinic.org**

Amount: $1,962,200.00

Project Scope: Establishes a 'One Door' integrated behavioral health and recovery navigation system uniting Moab Regional Hospital, the Moab Recovery Center, and Moab Free Health Clinic for substance use disorder (SUD) therapy, peer navigation, and primary care integration.

PATH 1.5: Behavioral Health - Primary Care Integration

Awardee: Wayne Community Healthcare (WCH)

Contact: **ruralht@utah.gov**

Amount: $1,422,434.00

Project Scope: Expands integrated primary care, mental health, and SDOH screening across 3 independent FQHCs (Wayne CHC, Creek Valley Health Clinic, Green River Medical Center) serving Wayne, Garfield, Washington, Emery, and Grand counties.

RISE Initiative

RISE 2.1 - 2.A: GME Strategic Plan

Awardee: University of North Carolina

Contact: **info@stategme.org / shepsgme.org**

Amount: $1,478,957.00

Project Scope: Delivers a 10-year statewide Graduate Medical Education (GME) strategic plan and physician gap analysis with Manatt Health, establishing accredited rural residency rotations and GME financing models with Utah medical centers and rural hospitals.

RISE 2.2: Rural Clinical Preceptor Stipends

Awardee: 73 Rural Clinical Preceptors

Year 1 Award: $156,000.00

Contact: **ruralht@utah.gov**

Project Scope: Funds direct stipends ($1K-$5K) for 73 rural clinical preceptors (MDs, DOs, APRNs, PAs) who train health professions students during rural rotations across 18 rural counties.

RISE 2.3: Grow Our Own

Awardee: Utah System of Higher Education (USHE) Talent Ready Utah (TRU)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **trugrants@ushe.edu**

Amount: $4,000,000.00

Project Scope: Awards competitive subgrant RFPs pairing K-12 school districts and higher education institutions with rural healthcare employers to establish dual-enrollment credentials, career exposure, and high school-to-certification pathways. Applications for year 1 were solicited from September 11 – October 29, 2026, TRU is currently evaluating application submissions.

RISE 2.4: Non-GME

Awardee: Utah System of Higher Education (USHE)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **trugrants@ushe.edu**

Amount: $3,000,000.00

Project Scope: Issues competitive subawards to technical colleges, universities, and rural healthcare employers to launch postsecondary non-GME clinical training, apprenticeships, and career ladders (CNAs, LPNs, medical assistants, paramedics, behavioral health techs). Applications for year 1 were solicited from September 11 – October 29, 2026, TRU is currently evaluating application submissions.

RISE 2.5: Recruit and Retain - Hospitals

Four (4) organizations were selected to serve as fiscal agents and administer funds to recruit and retain rural workforce. The awardees include the following:

Awardee: Utah Hospital Association (UHA)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **https://utahhospitals.org/ or Email: RHTP@utahhospitals.org**

Amount: $9,891,739.00

Project Scope: Allocates formula-based recruitment and retention subawards across 21 rural Critical Access and Prospective Payment System hospitals tied to 5-year rural service commitments. UHA is currently working directly with rural hospitals to administer this funding.

Click here for more information

Awardee: Association for Utah Health (AUCH)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **auch.org/rise or Email: RISE@auch.org**

Amount: $5,766,435.00

Project Scope: Manages recruitment and retention subawards for clinical staff across Utah's 11 rural FQHC organizations, providing signing bonuses, relocation assistance, housing support, and upskilling requiring 5-year service commitments.

Awardee: Utah Health Care Association (UTHCA)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **https://uthca.org/uhca-rise-2-5-grant-opportunity**

Amount: $2,364,000.00

Project Scope: Administers retention bonuses and recruitment incentives for nurses and clinical staff in eligible rural Skilled Nursing Facilities (SNFs) to build long-term care workforce stability tied to 5-year commitments.

Awardee: Rural Health Association of Utah (RHAU)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **info@rhau.org**

Amount: $2,015,350.00

Project Scope: Distributes recruitment/retention incentive subawards to clinicians in certified Rural Health Clinics and independent rural practices tied to 5-year rural service commitments.

SHIFT Initiative

SHIFT 3.1: Water Quality Infrastructure

Awardee: Department of Environmental Quality (DEQ)

Contact: **ruralht@utah.gov**

Amount: $4,200,000.00

Project Scope: Modernizes rural drinking water infrastructure, specifically funding capital water treatment facility upgrades to remove excess arsenic in the Ukon drinking water system (Box Elder County) per S.B. 3 requirements.

SHIFT 3.2: Rural Health Provider Networks

Five (5) organizations were selected to expand services and resources through rural health provider networks. The awardees include the following:

Awardee: Association for Utah Health (AUCH)

Contact: **auch.org/utahcommunityhealthcenternetwork or**

Email UCHCN@auch.org

Amount: $450,491.40

Project Scope: Expands quality data hubs, maternal health peer training, and clinical performance analytics across all rural FQHC organizations.

Awardee: Utah Rural Independent Hospital Network

Contact: **https://utahhospitals.org/ or Email: RHTP@utahhospitals.org**

Amount: $750,000.00

Project Scope: Supports the Rural 9 Independent Hospital Network (Beaver Valley, Blue Mountain, Central Valley, Gunnison, Kane, Milford, Moab, San Juan, Uintah Basin) with shared payer dashboards, denial management, patient outmigration analytics, and maternal/OB gap assessments.

Awardee: Rural Health Association of Utah (RHAU)

Contact: **info@rhau.org**

Amount: $360,000.00

Project Scope: Establishes RHC network operations, shared coding/billing technical assistance, revenue cycle audits, and operational support for rural health clinics.

Awardee: Intermountain Health Center (IHC)

Contact: **osp@imail.org**

Amount: $300,000.00

Project Scope: Establishes a shared community resource directory and CHW workforce training in Tooele County in partnership with the Center for Economic Opportunity and Belonging.

Awardee: University of Utah

Contact: **clinicalops@med.utah.edu**

Amount: $641,712.60

Project Scope: Establishes the Utah System for Trauma and Emergency Networks (USTN), linking registry data across rural hospitals and standardizing transfer handoffs to tertiary trauma centers.

SHIFT 3.3: Rural Emergency Medical Services

Awardee: Department of Public Safety (DPS)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **Utah BEMS RHTP SHIFT Initiative**

Amount: $12,500,000.00

Project Scope: Provides subgrants to rural EMS agencies for emergency vehicles and equipment upgrades, establishes Mobile Integrated Health / Community Paramedicine (MIH/CP) programs, funds EMT-to-Paramedic scholarships, and allocates specific funding for Tribal EMS infrastructure. Applications for year 1 were solicited from August 12 – September 20, 2026, DPS is currently evaluating application submissions.

SHIFT 3.4: New Models of Care

Eleven (11) organizations were selected to build new models for innovative care that expand access to and support prevention and management of chronic diseases, cancer, and behavioral health in rural communities. The awardees include the following:

Awardee: Association for Utah Health (AUCH)

Contact: **auch.org or email SHIFT@auch.org**

Amount: $1,692,803.00

Project Scope: Standardizes LMS orientation, purchases Lippincott clinical validation software, and deploys clinical task-trainer kits across rural FQHCs.

Awardee: Grand County

Contact: **ruralht@utah.gov**

Amount: $757,283.44

Project Scope: Operates a 4-tier centralized non-emergency medical transportation dispatch system providing local in-county rides and long-distance transit to Moab, Price, Grand Junction, and Salt Lake City.

Awardee: Intermountain Health Center (IHC)

Contact: **osp@imail.org**

Amount: $810,640.30

Project Scope: Embeds certified Community Health Workers and registered dietitians into rural clinics in Tooele and central/southern Utah for care navigation, benefit enrollment, chronic disease management, and medically tailored meal delivery.

Awardee: Moab Free Health Clinic

Contact: **www.moabfreehealthclinic.org. or Email: director@moabfreehealthclinic.org**

Amount: $830,879.75

Project Scope: Deploys bilingual Community Health Workers with Southeast Utah Health Department, establishes non-emergent ED diversion pathways with Moab Regional Hospital, and contracts academic faculty (U of U, BYU, SUU) for specialty tele-consults and intern supervision.

Awardee: Northwest Band of the Shoshone Nation (NWBSN)

Contact: **ruralht@utah.gov**

Amount: $1,225,675.00

Project Scope: Establishes a culturally tailored tribal primary care, preventive service, behavioral health, and CHW care delivery model serving tribal and rural residents in Box Elder County.

Awardee: Uintah Basin Medical Center (UBMC)

Contact: **ruralht@utah.gov**

Amount: $1,315,000.00

Project Scope: Establishes a permanent local Cardiology and Oncology specialty hub-and-spoke network in Roosevelt and Vernal clinics with Advanced Practice Providers and virtual urban specialist consults to eliminate 4-hour travel drives.

Awardee: Utah State University (USU)

Contact: **https://extension.usu.edu/tooele/ or Email: matthew.huntington@usu.edu**

Amount: $323,121.38

Project Scope: Trains certified peer recovery support specialists and provides technical coaching to 7 local mental health districts across 22 rural counties to integrate, supervise, and bill for peer recovery services.

Awardee: Building Blocks

Contact: **info@buildingblocks.org**

Amount: $1,102,297.20

Project Scope: Deploys Native peer recovery specialists and delivers culturally responsive SUD and mental health care across Navajo Chapter houses (Aneth, Montezuma Creek, Oljato, Navajo Mountain).

Awardee: Utah Navajo Health System (UNHS)

Contact: **info@unhsinc.org**

Amount: $1,054,450.00

Project Scope: Expands Community Health Workers and deploys the Activate CareLink platform across San Juan County clinics in Blanding, Monument Valley, Montezuma Creek, and Navajo Mountain to resolve social barriers.

Awardee: Gunnison Valley Hospital

Contact: **ruralht@utah.gov**

Amount: $167,260.00

Project Scope: Launches a Connected Care Hub in Sanpete County providing care navigation, tele-mental health access, and post-discharge follow-up care.

Awardee: U of U Physician Assistant Program (UPAP)/Switchpoint

Contact: **clinicalops@med.utah.edu**

Amount: $786,185.56

Project Scope: Embeds Community Health Workers and Case Managers into student-run free clinics operated by U of U PA, MD, and Physical Therapy students. Expands free clinic services to Switchpoint's Red Hills Stable Living Facility (110 residents) for primary care, PT, and health education. Subawards to Doctor's Volunteer Clinic for medical/dental/mental health expansion and Switchpoint for shelter case management.

FAST Initiative

FAST 4.1: Value Based Care

Awardee: Comagine

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **https://comagine.org/**

Amount: $2,000,000.00

Project Scope: Recruits rural providers into value-based payment models, establishes a Clinically Integrated Network (CIN) framework, designs clinician incentive models, and embeds Utah Health Information Network (UHIN) for bidirectional HIE. Comagine is currently soliciting interest. Expressing interest is the first step toward exploring how this initiative could support your organization and the communities you serve.

Interested in learning more or exploring participation?

- **Complete the Provider Interest Form (**Interest Form) to express your organization's interest.
- **Watch the Informational Webinar (**the recording and Slide Deck**)** to learn more about the initiative and opportunities available.

LIFT Initiative

LIFT 5.1 Telehealth Consortium

Awardee: Utah Education and Telehealth Network (UETN)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **RHTP-LIFT@uetn.org**

Amount: $26,500,000.00

Project Scope: Conducts a statewide telehealth needs assessment and awards competitive subgrants to rural hospitals, RHCs, CHCs, schools, and senior centers to scale direct-to-patient virtual care, remote patient monitoring (RPM), and specialty consults across all 25 rural counties. Applications for year 1 were solicited from July 10 – August 10, 2026, UETN is currently finalizing contracts.

SPRINT Initiative

SPRINT 3-1, 4-2, 4-3: Capital Infrastructure and Financial Sustainability

Awardee: Utah Hospital Association (UHA)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **https://utahhospitals.org/ or Email: RHTP@utahhospitals.org**

Amount: $38,300,000.00

Project Scope: Awards competitive capital grants for rural facilities to expand local service lines (ex. dialysis, cancer, OB, tele-ICU), upgrade diagnostic equipment, minor capital infrastructure renovations, optimize revenue cycle management, and pilot per-diem specialist coverage.

Apply for RFA Here

SPRINT 6-1, 6-5, 7-1, 7-2: Technology and Artificial Intelligence and Interoperability

Awardee: Utah Education and Telehealth Network (UETN)

[Fiscal Agent & Open Subgrant Administrator]

Contact: **RHTP-LIFT@uetn.org**

Amount: $20,900,000.00

Project Scope: Awards competitive grants to fund rural EHR modernization ($9.4M), deploy enterprise cybersecurity utilities with fractional CISOs ($4.5M), awards clinical AI/virtual scribe subgrants ($3.0M), and enhanced interoperability grants ($4.0M).

Apply for RFA Here

LINCS Initiative

LINCS 7.1 - 7A & 7B: Interoperability and HIE

Awardee: Utah Health Information Network (UHIN)

Contact: **uhin.org**

Amount: $3,000,000.00

Project Scope: Conducts a rural provider Health Information Exchange (HIE) readiness assessment and distributes non-competitive funding and technical assistance to connect rural hospitals, clinics, and tribal health entities to the state HIE for bidirectional data exchange.

LINCS 7.3-7.4: Semantic Data Model and Applications

Awardee: HK Consulting

Contact: **ruralht@utah.gov**

Amount: $11,000,000.00

Project Scope: Builds and deploys an open-source cloud-based semantic data translation platform that harmonizes disparate rural EHR, clinical, claims, and public health data into a single computable FHIR R4 format across 9 focus counties in Year 1.

Independent Contracts

Independent RHTP Program Performance Monitoring & Evaluation

Awardee: RTI International

Contact: **ruralht@utah.gov**

Amount: $1,668,126.29

Project Scope: Serves as the independent state data evaluation contractor overseeing all 4 Strategic Goals and 7 Interventions of Utah's $195.7M RHTP portfolio. Delivers Multi-Year Evaluation Plan within 60 days, Baseline Evaluation Report & Auditable Baseline Dataset (within 45 days of approved plan), Midline Evaluation Report (Dec 2028), and Endline Evaluation Report (Dec 2030). Evaluates population health status changes, rural health system performance, and long-term financial/operational sustainability models to prevent ongoing state financial liability.

Geospatial Mapping

Awardee: Utah Geospatial Resource Center

Contact: **ruralht@utah.gov**

Amount: $74,490

Project Scope: The objective of this Geographic Information Systems (GIS) engagement is to leverage geographic analysis to enhance strategic planning, improve resource visibility, and support data-informed decision-making across Utah's rural healthcare network.